

DEAR PARENTS**NEWSLETTER 21**

Kindly be informed that the mid-term break will take place on Thursday, 12th February, and Friday, 13th February for all students. Classes will resume on Monday, 16th February.

We wish our students a restful and enjoyable break.

WHAT WILL HAPPEN AT MAS

MAS will celebrate the first day of Ramadan on Thursday, February 19 with Abaya & Kandoura Day. Students are encouraged to wear traditional Emirati attire (Abaya for girls and Kandoura for boys) in celebration of the holy month.

SAFEGUARDING TIPS**Establish a Family Code Word**

Create a secret word only your family knows. If someone else claims to be sent by you, your child can ask for the code word before trusting them. Make sure they are:

- **Memorable but Not Obvious;** the best safe words are often slightly out of place, making them noticeable only to those in on the secret. For example, "pepperoni pizza" might be perfect if your child dislikes pepperoni, making its mention a clear signal. Other fun ideas could be "cucumber peach" (as one parent shared) or a favorite, slightly obscure character name like "dinglehopper" from a beloved movie. Some families even use colors, like "red" to indicate "stop everything immediately."
- **Age-Appropriate;** for younger children, a single, easily pronounced word is best. For older children or teens, a phrase or even a specific emoji (like the "X-plan" or a specific animal emoji) might work well for discreet texting.
- **A Family Decision;** involve your children in choosing the word. This gives them ownership and makes them more likely to remember and use it. Make it a fun, shared secret.

